



Mirror's Edge 2 coming

Former EA Senior Executive Ben Cousins has said that Mirror's Edge 2 is already "in production" at developer DICE

IE10 out for Windows 7

Microsoft released a redesigned Internet Explorer 10 for Windows 7, with no plans to release it for older versions of Windows

Feature



Apple's voice-assistant Siri

the galaxy!). Nevertheless, the trend seems to be picking up quite well and hazardously. Apart from it looking downright silly, we have seen people ask for directions from their phones and jaywalk on to the street. We've even seen people try talking to Siri on a plane and wonder why it isn't working?

Apple gives in (Bad)

If Steve Jobs could see the state of Apple today, he'd totally turn in his grave. The man was completely against the idea of a smaller iPad and a year after his death the device has seen the light of day. His legacy isn't upheld, but we'd let you decide if this was a good or a bad move on Apple's part. One reason why Apple probably caved in to this device is because in the recent past we have seen the rise of a number of 7-inch tablets and the price starts from a mere ₹6,000 and goes all the way up to ₹30,000. Steve Jobs had said, "The reason we [won't] make a 7-inch tablet isn't because we don't want to hit [a lower] price point. It's because we think the screen is too small to express the software. As a software driven company, we think about the software strategies first."

Android as an OS too is getting better by the day, and with budget tablets running on Android 4.0 ICS at the very least, Apple is facing some serious heat.

When Steve Jobs vowed to destroy Android he would have done a lot more than just shot him-

self in the foot as that's what Apple did. Tim Cook announced the replacement of Google Maps with its own maps app and the removal of YouTube as a native iOS app in iOS 6. Nokia phones today have better maps than iOS 6 and Tim Cook had to issue an apology note to consumers. Not only that, when the iPhone 5 went on sale, the 30-pin to lightning dock converter wasn't available.

Things aren't going well for Apple. In November 2012, the stock price of the company was at a six-month low.

Things are getting picture perfect (Good)

We have seen quite a few cameras hit store shelves this year that have impressed us. The highlight of the year, apart from the large array of cameras launched has to be that the potential of the cameras is increasing and its form factor and size is decreasing. Big sensors have found their way into small bodies and professional features, once found only in the high end cameras, have started making their way to the entry level and mid range DSLR's. The feature set has reached such a level that we have seen full frame sensors make an appearance in smaller cameras.

Cameras like the Sony RX100 are by no means DSLR replacements but they definitely make for a very good supplement. Its elder brother, the Sony RX1 houses a 24 MP full frame sensor in a compact body, which is great.

Two big guns that made headlines this year had to be the Nikon D800 and the



Sony RX1 sports a 24 MP full frame sensor

Canon 1DX. The Nikon D800 has a 36MP sensor as a highlight as well as some other great features like an RGB Matrix III meter (91,000 pixel), support for dual-memory card slots (CF and SDXC) and more.

The Canon 1DX on the other hand has an 18MP full frame sensor, 14 fps shoot speed, 61 point AF system with exceptional tracking and a weather sealed body making it a professional photographers wet dream.

Canon also released its first mirrorless interchangeable lens camera – the EOS M this year. Olympus updated its PEN line of cameras with the E-PL5 and launched its flagship mirrorless – the retro design sporting OM-D E-M5 earlier in the year. This will be a category to watch out next year.

Windows universe is divided into two platforms (Ugly)

Windows 8 is one of the biggest revamps to an operating system that we have seen in a long time. And this isn't necessarily a good thing. We put a Windows 8 powered desktop in front of a 45-year-old professional and she was stuck on the lock screen!

Consumers too are finding the new OS quite confusing as it offers a variety of versions (and this time it goes beyond the home, professional and elite editions) that work on a variety of hardware.

Windows 8 was designed keeping the touchscreen as well as mouse and keyboard in mind. This means that there are certain features that work best with a touchscreen, like navigating the start screen and there are some



The iPad Mini and iPad place side by side. Apple launched two new iPads this year